Forum:	Security Council (SC)
Issue:	Responding to the escalating instability in the Darfur Region following the Siege of El Fasher
Author:	Evangelia Maragaki
Position:	Deputy President

Personal Introduction

Dear delegates,

I am Evita Maragaki, and I am a student in the 12th grade at the German School of Athens. It is an honor to serve as a Deputy President in the Security Council (UNSC). I chose this committee because it allows me to exercise structured leadership in one of the most influential bodies of the UN system, guiding debate, ensuring procedural accuracy, and facilitating productive negotiations during crises.

To begin with, congratulations on deciding to take part in MUN, as it is an unforgettable experience with much to offer. As a past delegate, I strongly urge you to savor every moment and every step of the process. We live in an era in which we are facing urgent changes and challenges that demand immediate action. Throughout the entire MUN procedure, we learn about effective ways to take action and resolve these issues, as MUN raises awareness about these issues while encouraging cooperation.

Throughout the entire MUN procedure, we seek and formulate effective ways to take action and resolve these issues, as MUN raises awareness, at the same time encouraging cooperation. As UNSC delegate, you will be taking those abilities to the next level. You will be further translating this awareness into concrete diplomatic responsibility, proposing enforceable measures and evaluating the real-world implications of international action.

In this study guide, you will find an overview of the topic and all the basic information you need to know. However, to be as prepared as possible for the upcoming conference, I highly recommend and urge you to conduct your own independent research.

For any questions, whether about the study guide, additional study material, or issues that may arise during your research, please, do not hesitate to contact me or the main chair via email: evita_eins@hotmail.com, svatista18@gmail.com.

I am looking forward to the conference and meeting with you all!

Best regards,

Evangelia Maragaki

Introduction

Sudan has been experiencing a devastating civil war since April 2023, when fighting erupted between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF), Sudan's regular military, and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF), a powerful paramilitary group. Violence, displacement, and civilian suffering have intensified and become daily occurrences in this region. It is estimated that more than 150,000 people have been killed due to the conflict and approximately 14 million have been displaced from their homes across Sudan. This reflects the severity of the current Sudan war, which continues to destabilize the country and devastate civilian life.

El Fasher is a significant strategic point, as it is the capital of the North Darfur Region and was the key humanitarian access point, up until its fall. It was besieged for 18 months by the RSF, until it ultimately fell under its control on October 26, 2025, under the leadership of General Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo (Hemedti)[1]. This allowed the RSF to strengthen its hold on the broader Region, with it being a significantly advantageous area for the actor that has control thereover. That is why the outcome of the battle in El Fasher is determining the future trajectory of Sudan's conflict and the country's political future. This demonstrates why El Fasher matters; its fall shifted the balance of power and became a decisive turning point in the conflict.

The siege of El Fasher has sparked an outcry for human rights. According to Justin Lynch, a Sudan researcher and managing director of Conflict Insights Group[2], RSF's capture of El Fasher marks the beginning of what we fear to be a massacre of civilians.[3] The United Nations Humanitarian Chief noted that hundreds of thousands of civilians remain trapped in El Fasher, lacking access to food and healthcare, amid intense shelling and ground assaults within city bounds.[4] These developments illustrate what happened following El Fasher's capture: a rapid escalation of violence, collapse of services, and widespread civilian harm.

The fall of El Fasher therefore represents more than the loss of a single city. It is a major development in Sudan's ongoing war, with significant military, political, humanitarian, and regional consequences. Given the scale of civilian suffering and the potential for further regional destabilization, the situation requires sustained attention from the United Nations Security Council (UNSC), particularly

[1]"Sudan Crisis: RSF Captures El-Fasher, Pushing Darfur Into Total Collapse | African Security Analysis." Africansecurityanalysis.Org, 2025, https://www.africansecurityanalysis.org/updates/sudan-crisis-rsf-captures-el-fasher-pushing-darfur-into-total-collapse .

[2]Conflict Insights Group is a data analytics and conflict monitoring organization.

[3]Nimi Princewill. "Bloodbath Feared as Rebels Trap Thousands in Sudan City. How Did We Get Here and What Might Come Next?" CNN, 28 Oct. 2025, https://edition.cnn.com/2025/10/28/africa/sudan-rsf-takes-el-fasher-intl .

[4]ibid.

regarding civilian protection, humanitarian access, ceasefire efforts, and the prevention of further escalation.

Key Terms and Definitions

Ceasefire

A military order to cease firing, which means to stop all acts of war or the temporary cessation (pausing) of all hostile activities. It is strongly connected to the issue, as it is one of the main solutions proposed to help ease the turbulence in the region, and the only means to be able to provide all civilians in this region with the aid they need.

Extrajudicial killings / Summary Executions

"Extrajudicial killings, or extrajudicial executions, happen when someone in an official position deliberately kills a person without any legal process. Such arbitrary deprivations of life, which can also be carried out by militias, death squads or other non-State actors, often target political opponents, activists, or marginalized groups.". Extrajudicial killings are executions in which someone, usually a member of a militia, death squad, or non-state armed group, kills a person without legal process. This is connected to the topic, as many of the atrocities committed by the Janjaweed militia fall under this category.

[Political] Fragmentation

"Political Fragmentation is the process by which political entities become divided into smaller, often conflicting groups. This division can occur within a nation or across international borders, leading to a complex landscape of competing interests and alliances. Political fragmentation can impact governance, policy-making, and international relations by creating challenges in achieving consensus and cooperation. In a global context, it can influence diplomatic negotiations, economic partnerships, and security arrangements, making it a critical concept for understanding the dynamics of modern geopolitics."[5] The ongoing tensions between the SAF and RSF within the Darfur Region are a prime example of political fragmentation and its consequences.

Internally Displaced people

"Internally displaced people (IDPs) have been forced to flee their homes by conflict, violence, persecution or disasters, however, unlike refugees, they remain within their own country."[6] It is a term that refers to people who have been forced to leave their homes, without them wanting to do

[5]Bakar, Ergun. "Political Fragmentation: Definition, Conceptual Context & Why It Matters - TRT World Research Centre." TRT World Research Centre, 6 May 2026, https://researchcentre.trtworld.com/dictionary/political-fragmentation/ .

[6]"Internally Displaced People | UNHCR Ireland." UNHCR Ireland, 2024, https://www.unhcr.org/ie/about-unhcr/who-we-protect/internally-displaced-people .

so. Such is the case for many people who live in the Darfur Region, with lots of internally displaced people fleeing El Fasher, after it fell into the hands of the RSF.

Janjaweed militia

"Janjaweed is an Arab militia in Sudan, particularly in the Darfur region, that was most active in the first decade of the 2000s." It is a militia that has played an important role in the outcome of the war, and also the militia from which the RSF originates from.

Militia

The term militia carries different meanings. It can mean a part of the organized armed forces of a country liable to call only in emergency, a body of citizens organized for military service, the whole body of able-bodied male citizens declared by law as being subject to call to military service, a private group of armed individuals that operates as a paramilitary force and is typically motivated by a political or religious ideology. [7]

Paramilitary Group

It is a "group or organization that operates outside a country's formal military structure. Paramilitaries are typically modeled after military organizations and may have similar training and equipment. These groups often have political or ideological aims and may be involved in activities such as counterinsurgency, anti-terrorism, or internal security. They are often associated with governments but can also be used by non-state actors such as extremist groups or criminal organizations. Paramilitary organizations can be found in many countries, and their role and actions vary depending on their context."[8]

Rapid Support Forces

"Rapid Support Forces (RSF), Darfur-based paramilitary group in Sudan. The RSF was established in 2013 by the government to fight Sudanese rebels. After defeating those forces, the group grew into such a powerful and integral component of Sudan's defenses that it came to challenge Sudan's official military, the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF). The RSF and the SAF have been engaged in a war for supremacy since April 15, 2023, devastating the country."[9].

Sudanese Armed Forces

"The Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) are the official military of Sudan and one of the country's principal state institutions. Led by General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan, the SAF is responsible for

[7]Merriam-Webster. "Definition of MILITIA." Merriam-Webster.Com, 2019, https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/militia .

[8]Volle, Adam. "Paramilitary | Definition, Forces, & Examples | Britannica." Www.Britannica.Com, 10 May 2024, https://www.britannica.com/topic/paramilitary-armed-force .

[9]Volle, Adam. "Rapid Support Forces (RSF) | Leader, SAF, Sudan, & Support." Encyclopedia Britannica, 5 June 2025, https://www.britannica.com/topic/Rapid-Support-Forces .

defending Sudan's sovereignty, protecting its territorial integrity and maintaining national security. Since April 2023, the SAF has been one of the two main parties in the Sudan war, alongside the Rapid Support Forces (RSF)."[10]

Background Information

General Information about the Topic

Darfur is the historical region of the Billād al-Sūdān, which directly translates to the Land of the Blacks. It is the westernmost region of present-day Sudan. It lies between Kordofan to the east and Wadai to the west and extends southward to the Al-Ghazāl (Gazelle) River and northward to the Libyan Desert. Down below is a map showing visually the position of Sudan and the Darfur Region on the map. [11]

In the conflict there are many key players involved, both abroad and within Sudan. The Sudanese government was led by President Omar al-Bashir during the early years of the conflict and played a central role by arming and supporting the Janjaweed militias to suppress the rebellion. The Janjaweed militias are Arab militias that were instrumental in executing the government's counterinsurgency strategy. They also conducted widespread attacks on non-Arab villages, leading to mass atrocities. Key rebel groups include the Sudan Liberation Movement (SLM) and the Justice and Equality Movement (JEM). SLM is primarily composed of the Fur ethnic group and sought to address the political and economic marginalization of Darfur, while JEM has a broader national agenda and aims to reform Sudan's political system and address inequalities. The RSF were formed from the Janjaweed in 2013 and became a formal part of Sudan's security apparatus. Under the leadership of Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo (Hemedti), the group has been implicated in ongoing human rights abuses. International actors are also involved. The United Nations and the African Union deployed peacekeeping missions (UNAMID) to protect civilians and facilitate humanitarian aid, while the International Criminal Court issued arrest warrants for key figures, including President al-Bashir, on charges of genocide and crimes against humanity. Neighboring Countries are also heavily involved in the crisis, with Chad and Libya being notable examples.

For approximately 18 months the city of El Fasher was surrounded by the RSF. The city fell on 26 October 2025 after systematic artillery bombardments and the withdrawal of overstretched SAF units

[10]Now, Sudan. "Sudan Armed Forces (SAF)." Sudan Now, 24 July 2026, https://en.sudannow.net/explainers/sudan-armed-forces/ .

[11] "Sudan, Darfur Region Map - Bing." Bing, 2026, https://www.bing.com/images/search?view=detailV2&ccid=%2B0ZS01qR&id=863E1192384600E8E6423864CDCF80B77E928F3E&thid=OIP.-0ZS01qRStLxRV__qR-CUgHaHs&mediaurl=https%3A%2F%2Fd18x2uyjeekruj.cloudfront.net%2Fwp-content%2Fuploads%2F2025%2F09%2Fdarfur.jpg&cdnurl=https%3A%2F%2Fth.bing.com%2Fth%2Fid%2FR.fb4652d35a914ad2f1455fffa91f8252%3Frik%3DPo%252bSfreAz81kOA%26pid%3DImgRaw%26r%3D0&exph=632&expw=608&q=sudan%2C+darfur+region+map&FORM=IRPRST&ck=DDC57645363A82498F1A43BCB36C4E11&selectedIndex=6&itb=0&adlt=strict&cw=1375&ch=659&mode=overlay .

towards central Sudan. This positioned Hemedti, the leader of the RSF as the dominant military actor and potential power broker in future negotiations while Burhan's faction, the SAF, risked international marginalization. Thus, the battle for El-Fasher is not just a territorial shift, but a symbolic transition.

After the fall of the city over 30 million people, including 16 million children, are in need of humanitarian assistance due to famine, floods, cholera outbreaks, and war in Sudan. Consequently, Sudan's conflict can be described as one of the world's most acute humanitarian crises.

Seeing the dire situation of the region of Darfur the most effective committee in the UN to take action and resolve this issue is the UNSC. The UNSC has the power to adopt binding measures, including sanctions and demands for ceasefires, along with many other means of resolution. It has also taken action in the past such as on 30 October 2025 where it held an emergency session to condemn the atrocities that followed the RSF's entry into El Fasher, including the killing of nearly 500 people at the Saudi Maternity Hospital, the only partly functioning health facility that has survived repeated shelling, which is the throwing of explosive bombs.

Historical Roots of the conflict

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One cannot understand the Darfur conflict without considering its historical, environmental, and political foundations. The region has long faced tensions between local communities and the central government, driven by neglect, unequal development, and limited access to essential services. Ethnic tensions in the region are present as Darfur is home to diverse ethnic groups, broadly categorized as "Arab" and "non-Arab" communities. Historical grievances and competition over resources exacerbated ethnic divisions. The government's support for Arab militias against non-Arab rebel groups further deepened these divides. In 2003, the SLM and JEM launched attacks against government targets, citing the need to protect non-Arab populations and demand equitable resource distribution.

For decades, Darfur was often sidelined in national governance, leaving its communities with few economic opportunities and limited political representation. More specifically, infrastructure development, education, and healthcare services were minimal, leading to widespread dissatisfaction among the local population. This neglect fostered feelings of marginalization and resentment towards the central government. There is also resource competition and environmental stress. The arid and semi-arid conditions of Darfur have made water and arable land precious commodities. In times of scarcity, competition over these resources intensified, exacerbating existing ethnic and regional tensions. In the 1970s and 1980s, Darfur experienced severe droughts and desertification. These environmental challenges intensified competition over scarce resources like arable land and water, leading to increased tensions between nomadic herders and sedentary farmers.

Colonial-era borders and administrative systems disrupted long-standing social structures, and post-independence state-building, often centered on strong central authority at the expense of local autonomy, frequently deepened these divisions.

Several military confrontations have contributed to the development of the conflict in Darfur. One of the earliest major engagements was the Battle of Tine in 2003, during which rebel forces seized the town near the Chadian border, capturing weapons and supplies. The following year, government forces and Janjaweed militias besieged Geneina, resulting in mass killings and the displacement of thousands of civilians. Fighting continued in the following years, with the Battle of Muhajeria in 2007 seeing control of the town change hands repeatedly between opposing forces. In 2008, an attack on Kalma Camp, one of Darfur's largest camps for internally displaced persons (IDPs), resulted in numerous civilian deaths and drew international condemnation. Further clashes occurred in 2010 around Jebel Moon, a mountainous region in West Darfur where government-aligned forces and rebel groups frequently confronted one another.

The formation of the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) in 2013 marked another development in the conflict. That year, the group carried out raids across South and Central Darfur, displacing over 200,000 people. Villages were burned, while international observers and human rights organisations documented reports of rape and torture. Violence continued even after the removal of President Omar al-Bashir in 2019. In 2021, clashes broke out in Geneina, the capital of West Darfur, between Arab militias and Masalit civilians, with the RSF accused of involvement in the killings.

Following the outbreak of war between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the RSF in April 2023, fighting spread to Nyala, the capital of South Darfur. Much of the city's infrastructure was damaged, and more than 250,000 civilians fled amid gunfire, artillery strikes and looting. During the same period, El Geneina witnessed some of the most severe violence of the conflict. Between 2023 and 2024, RSF forces and allied Arab militias targeted Masalit communities, killing thousands and forcing tens of thousands to flee into neighbouring Chad. Entire neighbourhoods were destroyed, leaving large parts of the city deserted.

The Darfur war

After years of mounting tension in the region, the situation escalated on early 2003, when two rebel groups—the Sudan Liberation Movement (SLM) and the Justice and Equality Movement (JEM)—launched an armed uprising against the Sudanese government. The Darfur region experienced political and social exclusion by the Sudanese government, compounded by state-backed violence and systematic oppression targeting non-Arab communities. In response the Sudanese government armed and supported Arab militias known as Janjaweed. The Janjaweed militia carried out attacks on civilians, including mass killings, rape, and the displacement of millions of people Over the years the conflict evolved with the Janjaweed militias being reformed through institutional change to what is today known as RSF, while the atrocities committed remained as violent as they were before the

rebranding. The conflict has resulted in over 300,000 deaths and displaced more than 2.5 million people, making it one of the most severe humanitarian disasters of the 21st century.

El Fasher's geopolitical importance

El Fasher is a city that holds not only strategic but also symbolic importance. From the 17th to the 19th century, it was the cultural and religious heart of the Sultanate of Darfur. Its location is also of paramount importance as it is a hub for agriculture, livestock production and trade. Up until November 2023, El Fasher was the sole entry point for humanitarian aid from Port Sudan. Subsequent fighting and the siege in the region have hindered the humanitarian personnel' access to those in need.[12]

It also provides Hemedti's RSF with control of western supply lines into Libya and Chad, opening corridors for weapons, fuel, and cross-border trade. With the RSF now in control of every major Darfur capital, Sudan effectively faces a de facto territorial partition. The "alternative government" was the Government of Peace and Unity, commonly called the Tasis government. It is a rival governing authority established by the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) and allied political and armed groups to administer territories held by the RSF and its partners in western and southern Sudan. Sudan already had an army-backed authority based initially in Port Sudan and later associated with the return of state institutions toward Khartoum and the Tasis government introduced a second body claiming governmental authority, not merely local administration or rebel autonomy. The RSF now controls Darfur and large parts of Kordofan, reshaping Sudan's military landscape. This control disrupts SAF supply lines, gives RSF operational freedom for multi-pronged offensives and exposes SAF's Western Front. Control of North Darfur provides access to rear supply lines via: Libya, Chad, South Sudan and the Central African Republic.

Social and Humanitarian Conditions

Current Humanitarian Situation in El Fasher

Before the city fell, approximately 260,000 civilians were trapped inside it with no access to food, water, or medical care, according to an African Security Analysis Center. Children are no exception to the brutality of this siege, as according to UNICEF 130,000 children in El Fasher face extreme risks, including abduction, killing and maiming and sexual violence. Hospitals have run out of supplies, and humanitarian convoys have been blocked for months, while basic services like healthcare, education, and clean water are nearly nonexistent. Field reports describe widespread hunger, disease outbreaks, and imminent humanitarian collapse, while the UN has demanded safe passage for civilians and investigations into reported war crimes. According to a source " The International Organization for Migration (IOM) estimated that at least 62 000 people fled the El-Fasher area

[12]Bahreldin, Ibrahim Z. "Sudan's Army Has Been Battling to Keep Darfur's El Fasher From Paramilitary Forces – Why the City's so Important." The Conversation, 13 Aug. 2024, https://theconversation.com/sudans-army-has-been-battling-to-keep-darfurs-el-fasher-from-paramilitary-forces-why-the-citys-so-important-236168 .

between 26 and 29 October." Civilians attempting to flee toward Zamzam, Kutum, or the Chadian border face mined roads, RSF-controlled routes, and active fighting, thousands are trying to escape. Around 26,000 people fled since the fall of the city, many traveling on foot and arriving with accounts of ethnically and politically motivated killings.

RSF Actions and Human Rights Abuses

RSF fighters remain embedded in residential areas, preventing civilians from escaping. Documented abuses include summary executions, looting and destruction of property, assaults on civilians, and house-to-house raids. Within 48 hours of the RSF attack on El Fasher, more than 2,000 civilians were killed, according to armed groups allied with the Sudanese army. Yale's Humanitarian Research Lab also found evidence of systematic mass killings, visible even in satellite imagery.

Genocide Indicators

Primary targets of RSF violence include non-Arab groups: the Fur, Zaghawa, and Masalit peoples. In 2023, RSF forces massacred up to 15,000 Masalit people in El-Geneina. Experts warn that RSF control of western Sudan may allow large-scale ethnic cleansing. Experts warn the violence may represent a "point of no return", making peace or reconstruction nearly impossible. Neither SAF nor RSF is willing to commit to a ceasefire, due to strategic, battlefield motivations, deep polarization and no trust between parties.

Broader Consequences of the Darfur Conflict (2003–Present)

Agriculture and livestock have been destroyed by the conflict, worsening the already weak economy. This is causing great disruption to trade routes and market towns. Restoration of the economy is estimated in billions of euros. The weakening of central authority is deepening regional divides and leading to the destabilization of Sudan's post 2019 transitional government. However, the effects of the siege of El Fasher are felt everywhere in the region. The war along with its geopolitical entanglements are a direct threat to fuel another/further escalation, proxy wars, and spill into neighboring countries, along the highly strategic shores of the Red Sea where the interests of many countries converge and collide. Neither SAF nor RSF is willing to commit to a ceasefire, due to strategic, battlefield motivations, deep polarization and no trust between parties. This highlights the humanitarian and regional consequences, showing how the crisis threatens broader regional stability and international security.

Link to today's instability

Prolonged conflict has systematically destroyed the region's foundations, including infrastructure, agriculture, trade routes, and basic public services. Livelihoods have collapsed, leaving communities dependent on humanitarian assistance for survival. Chronic insecurity is also noted in the region as displacement, food shortages, and attacks on civilians have become a permanent feature of daily life. Underlying tensions accumulated over decades, making the fall of El Fasher a breaking point rather than an isolated event. Any response must combine not only emergency relief but also broader

political and security solutions, directly implemented under the supervision and recommendation of the UNSC.

Timeline of Events

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Date	Description of Event
17th - 19th Century	El Fasher was the cultural and religious heart of the Sultanate of Darfur. [13]
1970s - 1980s	Darfur experienced severe droughts and desertification, intensifying competition over land and water, exacerbating tensions between nomadic herders and sedentary farmers. Darfur's droughts and desertification intensified resource scarcity and fueled conflict between herders and farmers.
Early 2003	In 2003, the SLM and JEM launched attacks against government targets, citing the need to protect non-Arab populations and demand equitable resource distribution. The Darfur War began.
2004	Siege of Geneina: Government and Janjaweed forces besieged the town, leading to mass killings and the displacement of thousands. [14]
30 July 2004	The UNSC adopted the resolution 1556. First major UNSC response to Darfur; demanded Sudan disarm the Janjaweed, protect civilians,

[13] Bahreldin, Ibrahim Z. "Sudan's Army Has Been Battling to Keep Darfur's El Fasher From Paramilitary Forces – Why the City's so Important." The Conversation, 13 Aug. 2024, https://theconversation.com/sudans-army-has-been-battling-to-keep-darfurs-el-fasher-from-paramilitary-forces-why-the-citys-so-important-236168 .

[14] "The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

Date	Description of Event
	and allow aid, but implementation was weak and violence continued. [15]
5 May 2006	Signed in Abuja, Nigeria, this agreement aimed to end hostilities between the Sudanese government and the SLM. However, not all rebel factions agreed to the terms, leading to continued violence. Abuja Negotiations
2007	Battle of Muhajeria: A strategic town contested by various factions, its control changed hands multiple times, reflecting the fragmented nature of the conflict.[16]
31 July 2007	UNSC adopted the resolution 1769. Created UNAMID to protect civilians and support peace; the most ambitious mission, yet hampered by insecurity, access limits, and weak cooperation. [17]
2008	Attack on Kalma Camp: One of the largest IDP camps in Darfur was attacked, resulting in numerous civilian deaths and attracting international condemnation. Kalma Camp, hosting over 90,000 internally displaced persons, became a symbol of the humanitarian crisis in the region. [18]

[15]UN. Security Council (59th year : 2004. "Resolution 1556 (2004) / Adopted by the Security Council at Its 5015Th Meeting, on 30 July 2004." United Nations Digital Library System, UN, 30 July 2004, https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/527076/usage?v=pdf .

[16]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

[17]Security, UN. "Resolution 1769 (2007) /: Adopted by the Security Council at Its 5727Th Meeting, on 31 July 2007." United Nations Digital Library System, UN, 31 July 2007, https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/604309 .

[18]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

Date	Description of Event
2009	2009 ICC Arrest Warrant for al-Bashir: The ICC's decision to issue an arrest warrant for President al-Bashir marked a significant moment, signaling international commitment to accountability. Nevertheless, al-Bashir remained in power until 2019. [19]
2010	Battle of Jebel Moon (2010): This mountainous region in West Darfur saw frequent clashes between government-aligned forces and rebel groups. The rugged terrain made it a rebel stronghold, and government airstrikes targeted the area repeatedly. [20]
20 February 2010	2010 Framework Agreement proposed ceasefire and negotiation framework between Sudan and JEM. It briefly created momentum but excluded key armed actors and was weakly implemented. [21]
14 July 2011	The 2011 Doha Document is the most detailed non-UN Darfur peace deal (ceasefire, compensation, wealth-sharing, governance). Many groups did not sign and implementation was uneven.[22]
2013	2013 RSF Raids: The Rapid Support Forces launched coordinated attacks across South and Central Darfur, displacing over 200,000 people. Villages were burned, and reports of systematic

[19]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

[20]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

[21]"Framework Agreement to Resolve the Conflict in Darfur Between the Government of Sudan and the JEM | PA-X." Peaceagreements.Org, 2018, https://www.peaceagreements.org/agreements/755/ .

[22]"DOHA DOCUMENT for PEACE in DARFUR (DDPD)." https://unamid.unmissions.org/sites/default/files/ddpd_english.pdf . Accessed 11 Aug. 2026.

Date	Description of Event
	rape and torture were documented by international observers and human rights organizations. [23]
2019	2019 Sudanese Revolution: Mass protests led to the ousting of al-Bashir, raising hopes for democratic reforms and peace. However, the subsequent power struggle between military and civilian factions have led to renewed instability.[24]
3 October 2020	The 2020 Juba Agreement was a broad Sudan peace deal integrating Darfur rebels into politics and security; mixed implementation and persistent fragmentation led to renewed violence. [25]
2021	Geneina Clashes. Following the 2019 ousting of Omar al-Bashir, violence erupted again in West Darfur's capital, Geneina, between Arab militias and Masalit civilians. The RSF was accused of complicity in the killings. Over 100 people were reported dead in a few days. [26]
Until November 2023	Up until November 2023, El Fasher was the sole entry point for humanitarian aid from Port Sudan, which facilitated the distribution of international aid to other areas. Subsequent

[23]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

[24]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

[25] sudan_juba_agreement_3_oct_2020.pdf

[26]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

Date	Description of Event
	fighting and the siege in the region have hindered aid workers' access to those in need.[27]
2023	Nyala Offensive. During the broader conflict between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the RSF, fighting reached Nyala, the capital of South Darfur. The city's infrastructure was devastated, and more than 250,000 civilians fled the area amid gunfire, artillery strikes, and looting. [28]
April 2023	Estimates show that more than 150 000 people have been killed in the conflict since April 2023, and about 12 million have been displaced. [29]
2023-2024	El Geneina Massacres. These were among the most brutal incidents in the post-2019 phase of the conflict. Arab militias, often supported by RSF elements, targeted Masalit communities, killing thousands and displacing tens of thousands into eastern Chad. Entire neighborhoods were emptied and burned. [30]
8 March 2024	The UNSC adopts resolution 2724. It called for a Ramadan ceasefire and humanitarian access in Sudan. Fighting continued and escalation

[27]Bahreldin, Ibrahim Z. "Sudan's Army Has Been Battling to Keep Darfur's El Fasher From Paramilitary Forces – Why the City's so Important." The Conversation, 13 Aug. 2024, https://theconversation.com/sudans-army-has-been-battling-to-keep-darfurs-el-fasher-from-paramilitary-forces-why-the-citys-so-important-236168 .

[28]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

[29]"The Fall of El-Fasher: Sudan's War Outpaces Truce Plan." European Union Institute for Security Studies, 4 Nov. 2025, https://www.iss.europa.eu/publications/commentary/fall-el-fasher-sudans-war-outpaces-truce-plan

[30]"The Darfur Conflict (2003–Present) - War Wings Daily." War Wings Daily - Military & Aviation News, 9 May 2025, https://warwingsdaily.com/wars/the-darfur-conflict-2003-present/.

Date	Description of Event
	around Darfur/El Fasher persisted, highlighting recent enforcement failures. [31]
26 October 2025	The city of El Fasher fell under the jurisdiction of the RSF. [32]
26 - 29 October 2025	According to IOM at least 62 000 people fled El Fasher, following its siege.[33]
30 October 2025	UNSC holds an emergency session regarding the atrocities that followed after the siege of El Fasher by the RSF. [34]
October 2025	The commander of the Janjaweed militia, Ali Muhammad Ali Abd-Al-Rahman, also known as Ali Kushayb, was convicted in October 2025 by the ICC for war crimes and crimes against humanity committed in West Darfur between 2003 and 2004. He was found guilty on 27 counts, including murder, rape, torture, persecution, forcible transfer, and pillaging, and was sentenced in December 2025 to 20 years' imprisonment. This marks the first full conviction related to the Darfur atrocities and underscores the Janjaweed's role not only as a militia but as part of the legal and moral background of the current crisis in Darfur.

[31]UN. Security Council (79th year : 2024. "Resolution 2724 (2024) / Adopted by the Security Council at Its 9568Th Meeting, on 8 March 2024." United Nations Digital Library System, UN, 8 Mar. 2024, https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/4040187 .

[32]DNHR. "Darfur's Deepening Catastrophe: What Is Happening in El Fasher and Why the World Must Not Look Away - DNHR." DNHR, 18 Nov. 2025, https://dnhr.org/2025/11/18/el-fasher-crisis-darfur-humanitarian-catastrophe/ .

[33]"The Fall of El-Fasher: Sudan's War Outpaces Truce Plan." European Union Institute for Security Studies, 4 Nov. 2025, https://www.iss.europa.eu/publications/commentary/fall-el-fasher-sudans-war-outpaces-truce-plan

[34]"The Fall of El-Fasher: Sudan's War Outpaces Truce Plan." European Union Institute for Security Studies, 4 Nov. 2025, https://www.iss.europa.eu/publications/commentary/fall-el-fasher-sudans-war-outpaces-truce-plan

Date	Description of Event
December 2025	The commander of the Janjaweed militia was sentenced to 20 years in prison, following his prosecution by the ICC.[35]

Major Actors Involved

Chad

Chad is one of the most important neighboring countries in the Darfur crisis because instability inside Sudan's Darfur region spills across their shared border, bringing refugee flows, security risks, and humanitarian pressure into Chadian territory, thus placing extra control on its eastern border. Its action remains mainly in controlling the population movement across the frontier protecting civilians on both sides of the border, and reducing the risk of wider regional spillover that could involve Chad any further into this conflict. The Chadian government along with international and humanitarian actors, supports the creation and maintenance of refugee camps, and provide emergency assistance to the displaced population from the Darfur Region. It also tries through diplomacy to focus on the de-escalation of the conflict, promote ceasefires and maintain regional stability.

Egypt

Egypt has increased security measures along the border and emphasized the need to prevent such cross-border threats from taking root. Egypt is also in favor of the unity of Sudan and strongly objects to its division, as it believes in the existence of a unified and single Sudanese state. From Egypt's perspective, a broken or divided Sudan would deepen the conflict, empower militias, and create lasting security vacuums on Egypt's southern border. It has positioned itself as a diplomatic actor, which endorses a humanitarian truce, a nationwide ceasefire, and broader political talks, to put a definitive end to the Darfur war. It cooperates with international and regional actors, including the United Nations and the African Union, to push for de-escalation and to support mediation efforts. It uses its political weight and influence to pressure the warring parties toward negotiation, making its involvement relevant to any serious response strategy.

Sudan

Sudan is the most important actor in this crisis because the war is unfolding inside its territory and reflects a profound breakdown of state authority and civilian protection. The ongoing civil war has

[35] "Ali Muhammad Ali Abd-Al-Rahman Declared Guilty of War Crimes and Crimes Against Humanity Committed in Darfur, Sudan." International Criminal Court, 2025, https://www.icc-cpi.int/news/ali-muhammad-ali-abd-al-rahman-declared-guilty-war-crimes-and-crimes-against-humanity .

severely undermined the government's ability to protect civilians, restore basic services, and ensure humanitarian access. The fighting between the SAF and the RSF makes fulfilling these duties even harder. As the conflict is not only directly endorsing the collapse of the state but also the security and the governance structures of the country.

The war between the SAF and the RSF has turned Darfur into a front line rather than a protected region, with civilians caught between the agendas of the two competing militias, which are directly involved in the struggle to regain control of Darfur and neighboring Kordofan from the RSF. They have been deploying troops and conducting operations to retake these areas, further militarizing the region and intensifying the humanitarian crisis. The siege of El Fasher greatly exposed the state's inability to confront and manage national crises, as well as its failure to protect its own civilians from mass atrocities.

Throughout history, Sudanese governments can also be held responsible for contributing to the outbreak of this civil war, in part due to earlier counterinsurgency campaigns that were widely accused of atrocities against civilians. Human rights reports from the first Darfur war documented massacres, summary executions, village burnings, and forced displacement carried out by government and allied forces, creating patterns of violence and impunity that have echoed into the current conflict. Thus distrust in state institutions helped fuel the fragmentation that now threatens Sudan's survival as a unified state.

Today, Sudan is both a victim of fragmentation and a central actor whose institutions must be part of any credible ceasefire, humanitarian access arrangement, and reconstruction plan. At the same time, it is a nation whose military and political choices will shape whether instability worsens or begins to ease, making the behavior of the SAF and other state actors decisive for the country's future and for regional stability.

Janjaweed

They are Arab militias operating in Sudan, most notably in the Darfur Region, where they are considered one of the most feared armed actors of the area. They have been playing a central role in the conflicts erupting in this region, since the beginning of the Darfur Wars in 2003, where the Sudanese government employed them as proxy forces against rebel movements. They are widely accused of committing inhumane acts, such as village burnings, killings, rape, looting, and the forced displacement of non-Arab communities. This is also one of the reasons why the Darfur. One of their commanders, Ali Muhammad Ali Abd-Al-Rahman, also known as Ali Kushayb, was convicted in October 2025 by the ICC for war crimes and crimes against humanity committed in West Darfur between 2003 and 2004.

Rapid Support Forces (RSF)

The RSF are one of the two main actors involved in this conflict, along with the SAF. Now it has its own independent command structure, finance networks, and territorial influence. Over time, the

group expanded beyond Darfur and embedded itself across Sudan, becoming a central power broker in national politics and security. It directly drove the siege of El Fasher and controlled or contested territory across much of Darfur, holding not only military but also significant political power. It constitutes half of the core power struggle in Sudan, participating in a war for supremacy with the SAF since April 2023. It is also responsible for the worsening of displacement, insecurity, and threats to civilians in North Darfur.

As it is deeply connected to the region's history, local armed networks, and patterns of civilian abuse, the group played a central role in the siege and eventual capture of El Fasher, which UN investigators say bears "the hallmarks of genocide" against the Fur and Zaghawa communities. It is also accused of serious abuses such as extrajudicial killings, torture, arbitrary detention, ethnic targeting, sexual violence, blocking humanitarian aid, and using starvation and access restrictions as weapons of war. The RSF is also part of the wider regional environment that adds to the war's external support networks, drawing on cross-border alliances and resources. Despite being a non-state armed group, the RSF is a key diplomatic actor whose influence is indirect but important, as any ceasefire, political settlement, or humanitarian access arrangement must account for its power and interests.

Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF)

It is the official state military and one of the two main combatants in the war that shapes the instability in Darfur. Following the siege and eventual fall of El Fasher on 26 October 2025, it has been trying to protect the remaining state-controlled regions and prevent the RSF from bringing the whole of northern Darfur under its control. It carried out airstrikes and shelling against RSF positions in Darfur as part of its efforts to regain control of the region, using its air force, heavy artillery, and drones. These actions ended up being a double-edged sword: although intended to protect civilians and weaken RSF capabilities, they have also contributed to civilian casualties and the destruction of infrastructure, including strikes on markets, hospitals, and other civilian sites. It is collaborating with allies and local partners in some areas of Darfur to help the resistance against the RSF, including armed movements that signed the Juba Peace Agreement and local self-protection groups. Nevertheless, it remains the main institution capable of challenging RSF expansion and preserving some form of state authority in Sudan.

UN Documents and International Agreements

Security Council Resolution 1556

It is the first notable response of the UNSC to the escalation of the conflict in Darfur, with this resolution being officially adopted on 30 July 2004. It essentially demanded that the government of Sudan disarm the Janjaweed militias, apprehend and bring to justice leaders and associates who incited and carried out violations of human rights and international humanitarian law, and it endorsed the deployment of international (African Union-led) monitors. Moreover, it also urged states to provide support and requested reporting on progress.

2006 Darfur Peace Agreement

In 2006, for the resolution of the Darfur conflict there was an attempt at political settlement through the 2006 Darfur Peace Agreement, signed on 5 May 2006. It was a peace agreement between the Sudanese Government and a faction of the Sudan Liberation Movement, aimed at ending the conflict through arrangements that included power sharing, compensation, and security arrangements, which intended to reduce violence and create a political settlement.

Security Council Resolution 1706

It was adopted on 31 August 2006 by the UNSC. It sought to expand the UN Mission in Sudan (UNMIS) into Darfur to support implementation of the Darfur Peace Agreement and strengthen civilian protection by authorizing a significant increase in military and police personnel for deployment to Darfur. The proposed expansion included up to 17,300 military personnel, 3,300 civilian police officers and 16 formed police units, with a mandate to support humanitarian assistance, monitor security arrangements and protect civilians under imminent threat. However, it should be noted that the resolution invited Sudan's consent to the deployment, that Security Council authorization alone could not ensure host-state cooperation, and Sudan's opposition ultimately prevented UNMIS from deploying to Darfur. The military component included 360 observers and liaison officers, and was designed to strengthen the mission's ability to monitor security, support civilian protection and operate across Darfur; UNAMID incorporated AMIS personnel and formally took over from that mission on 31 December 2007. The large authorized force marked an effort to move beyond a limited observer presence, but its practical impact depended on personnel and equipment being deployed and on the mission's access and operational capacity.

Security Council Resolution 1769

On 31 July 2007 the UNSC adopted Resolution 1769. This resolution created the African Union–United Nations Hybrid Operation in Darfur (UNAMID). Its goal was to protect civilians, support the peace process, monitor arms violations, and help reduce violence, authorizing up to 19,555 military personnel and a substantial police component.

2010 Framework Agreement to Resolve the Conflict in Darfur

A non-UN-affiliated move to resolve the issue in Darfur. It was signed on the 20th February 2010 and was a framework between the Sudanese government and the Justice and Equality Movement (JEM) that committed the parties to an immediate ceasefire, the integration of JEM forces, and further negotiations on administrative reorganization, wealth-sharing, and other issues.

2011 Doha Document for Peace in Darfur

The 2011 Doha Document for Peace in Darfur signed on 14 July 2011 is the most detailed non-UN peace framework for Darfur. It was finalized at an All-Darfur Stakeholders Conference and formalized between Sudan and the Liberation and Justice Movement, addressing ceasefire arrangements, compensation, wealth-sharing, and Darfur governance while creating institutions to address root causes.

2020 Juba Agreement for Peace in Sudan

The 2020 Juba agreement for Peace in Sudan was signed on 3 October 2020. It was a wider peace agreement between Sudan's transitional authorities and several armed movements, including Darfur-based groups such as SLM and JEM, that sought to integrate former rebels into political and security structures and address grievances through power-sharing, land rights, and transitional justice.

Security Council Resolution 2724

It was adopted on 8 March 2024, calling for the immediate cessation of hostilities in Sudan during Ramadan and urged all parties to seek a sustainable resolution through dialogue, while demanding undisturbed humanitarian access and compliance with international humanitarian law.

Previous Attempts to Solve the Issue

2004 N'Djamena Humanitarian Ceasefire

It was signed on 8 April 2004 in N'Djamena, Chad, and was one of the earliest formal attempts to reduce the violence that occurred in the Darfur region, by creating a temporary halt to fighting. It was supported by the Chadian government, and also had the support of the AU, as well as other international parties. It concerned the Government of Sudan and the two main rebel movements at the time the SLM and the JEM, and enforced a 45 day long automatically renewable ceasefire, that covered both land and air military operations. Its core intention was to allow humanitarian access to reach the war affected areas and population, while space for negotiation was going to be opened, as military parties were suspended from military actions, had to release prisoners of war, were to refrain from recruitment and arm supply, and lift all movement restrictions of people and goods. To ensure that all military actors would comply a ceasefire commission was created and the AU subsequently deployed observers and protection troops to help with the monitoring of compliance.

In theory it seems to have been one of the most effective solutions at the time. However, in practice, the ceasefire proved to have limited success. Violations of the ceasefire were a common occurrence, with government-backed janjaweed militias not respecting the truce, and continuing the attack on civilians and the obstruction of humanitarian aid. Human rights organizations criticized the deal for lacking a strong international monitoring mechanism and for not explicitly covering human rights monitoring, which weakened accountability for ongoing abuses. By September 2004, the Security Council was already deploring "recent ceasefire violations by all parties" in Resolution 1564, underscoring how quickly the N'Djamena arrangement proved fragile despite its humanitarian intent. Overall, the N'Djamena Humanitarian Ceasefire was an important first step in putting Darfur on the diplomatic agenda and in establishing a framework for AU monitoring and humanitarian access, but its limited enforcement, partial compliance by key actors, and continued violence meant it functioned more as a temporary pause than a durable solution.

2004 Abuja Negotiations

The 2004 Abuja negotiations were part of a broader effort to create a political settlement between the Sudanese government and Darfur rebel movements, with the end goal being the addressing of security, power-sharing, and the humanitarian crisis through dialogue. It was sponsored by the AU and was held in Abuja, Nigeria. The main actors in those talks were Khartoum and the two main rebel groups at the time SLM and JEM, who underwent many rounds of discussions that produced protocols in security and humanitarian issues in November 2004. Those agreements were to improve security in the Darfur region and facilitate humanitarian access.

However, those talks ultimately failed, due to the deep division and mistrust between the parties that participated in these talks. The Sudanese government also refused to fully meet all security obligations stated by the protocols created. The ongoing violence, the rebel walkouts mid 2004 and then again in December 2004 from those talks, greatly undermined their effectiveness. It was later found by analysts that mutual mistrust, weak mediation capacity, inconsistent participation, rebel fragmentation, and an inability to agree on core power- and resource-sharing and security arrangements were the key reasons why the 2004 Abuja round collapsed.

2007 Tripoli Agreement

This agreement, which is often referred to as the 2007 Tripoli Consensus on the Political Process for Darfur, aimed to improve relations among Darfur factions and support a broader peace process by encouraging dialogue and political compromise. Its intention was to reduce fragmentation among armed groups and bring more actors into a unified negotiating framework, building on earlier initiatives such as the 2006 Darfur Peace Agreement and the AU-UN push for a hybrid operation.

In practice, however, the initiative had next to no long-term effect. Seeing as the implementation was weak, the underlying drivers of the conflict were left unaddressed, and rebel fragmentation continued to grow, by mid-2007 there were dozens of rebel splinter groups, and successive mediation efforts, including Tripoli, failed to bridge the gaps between Khartoum and the many armed opposition groups, leaving the security and humanitarian crisis largely intact.

2019 Sudanese Political Transition

After the fall of Omar al-Bashir in April 2019, Sudan entered a transition that raised hope for a new approach to Darfur. The 2019 Constitutional Declaration established a civilian–military transitional government, a Sovereign Council and cabinet, with promises of more inclusive governance and renewed peace efforts, including implementation of the 2020 Juba Peace Agreement and attention to conflict-affected regions like Darfur.

However, these promises were only partially realized. Instability, persistent military influence, and armed-group fragmentation undermined the process. Violence in Darfur increased in some areas after 2019, justice and implementation of peace deals moved slowly amid divisions among political

and military actors, and the transition ultimately failed to consolidate civilian rule or deliver a durable settlement for Darfur

Possible Solutions

Strengthening Protection of Civilians

One of the possible solutions could be to strengthen the protection of the civilians. Under international law, civilians are to be protected by any war attacks, from the countries/parties involved in each conflict. So, the SC being the only committee of the UN, with the power to dictate what ought to be done, ought to find and explain how measures ought to be implemented, to ensure the enhancement of civilian protection in conflict-affected areas. Such measures could be mechanisms, designed to deter attacks on civilians and civilian infrastructure, because as seen in the Darfur region, those attacks worsened the already worse conditions of life of the civilians.

They could also enforce sanctions, to any party of the conflict that does not comply with the international humanitarian law. In order to be able to verify and be aware of any possible violation, international monitoring, reporting mechanisms ought to be in place. Those monitoring and reporting mechanisms ought to investigate alleged violations of international humanitarian and human rights law. For that either already existing legal institutions could be used, however they ought to be reformed, to ensure that they are effective, or create new international legal institutions that are going to be built and have as their only purpose to strengthen the protection of civilians.

Facilitating Humanitarian Access

Having mentioned the terrible circumstances under which the people in the Darfur region, and the lack of humanitarian aid, the UNSC could use its power to open ways for other actors to provide aid. It should propose ways to ensure safe, rapid, and unhindered humanitarian access. Actions taken can also entail negotiated humanitarian pauses or localized ceasefires, which will be mandatory and set by the UNSC.

Another way to facilitate humanitarian access in the Darfur region would be to strengthen the coordination between the UN, humanitarian agencies, and regional actors. Some preventative actions could also be helpful in ensuring there is humanitarian access in the devastated regions. The UNSC should enforce some rules that address all possible obstacles that may arise during an aid delivery, how to protect humanitarian personnel, etc., to make sure that nothing is hindering the access of humanitarian access, as it has happened multiple times in the past.

Supporting Diplomatic Engagement

Diplomatic engagement is essential to achieving a ceasefire and a lasting political settlement in Darfur, but previous initiatives have yet to end the conflict. The Security Council should support coordinated mediation by the UN, the African Union and IGAD, and encourage the parties to take part in inclusive, Sudanese-led negotiations. It could endorse a shared negotiating framework,

Commented [3]: This section includes good ideas but it would be good to see more active solutions with a less theoretical approach. While the possible solutions should not be structured as clauses it would help to include more specific solutions

Commented [4]: I would make a sub-section about the implementation of a UN peacekeeping operation, aka Blue Helmets. As there have been failed peacekeeping efforts perhaps make a paragraph finding a solution so that their deployment could really help

Commented [5]: Expand more on how the protection will be strengthened. In the paragraph you are mentioning some very interesting ideas. Perhaps it would be best to expand on the monitoring mechanisms and the sanctions in different sub-sections. Strengthening protection of civilins is the goal so take the ideas from this sub-section and create perhaps one only for monitoring and one for sanctions

Commented [6]: this is currently too broad. Specify which existing SC mechanisms could actually strengthen civilian protection. Also reconsider proposing a new international legal institution unless you can explain why existing mechanisms are insufficient, who would establish it, its jurisdiction and how it would operate. so yea

Commented [7]: What kind of mechanisms

Commented [8]: Very good idea

Commented [9]: i agree, good direction, but distinguish between what the Council can demand, what requires negotiation/consent on the ground, and what can realistically be enforced. A resolution calling a humanitarian pause “mandatory” does not by itself create compliance; explain monitoring and consequences for obstruction!

request regular updates from mediators on progress and obstacles, and promote confidence-building measures such as localized humanitarian pauses and agreements to facilitate aid delivery, and also consider targeted pressure on actors who obstruct negotiations or violate ceasefire commitments, while offering incentives for meaningful participation and compliance. It should support the process, not compel mediators or the parties to accept a predetermined outcome.

Enhancing Regional Cooperation

As mentioned in the previous solution, and as seen in the previous attempts to the solution, regional cooperation is highly important. Cross-border instability places an important factor in this crisis, and it must be addressed. One way this could happen is by strengthening the cooperation between neighboring countries. Often arms are being smuggled from one country to another. To deal with such a situation regional efforts, with the collaboration of many regional actors, are one of the main solutions to prevent arms trafficking across borders and the resulting violence caused. Furthermore, coordination between regional actors must be improved, when it comes to refugee protection and regional humanitarian response. Blockage of aid, floods of refugees crossing borders, are requiring constant coordination between regional actors.

This can be achieved either through treaties, specializing in coordination, and joint diplomatic initiatives that involve regional stakeholder, be it countries, rebels, organizations, etc, under the jurisdiction and guidance of the UNSC. The Security Council should encourage the AU, IGAD, the UN and Sudan's neighbours to coordinate border monitoring, share verified information on suspected arms trafficking, and refer evidence to the relevant UN sanctions-monitoring bodies. At the same time UNHCR, IOM and host governments can coordinate refugee protection and humanitarian assistance, while the AU and IGAD align mediation and ceasefire efforts with existing processes.

Utilizing Sanctions

This solution aims to improve effectiveness and precision in how the UNSC uses sanction mechanisms to help resolve this issue, while minimizing unintended consequences for civilians and actors that do not contribute to regional instability in this region. First of all, the precision of targeted sanctions must be enhanced. Clear criteria could be established along with stronger evidentiary standards for designating individuals and entities responsible for contributing to regional instability, while also regularly reviewing exciting designation to ensure that sanctions remain justified and proportionate. Existing arms embargoes should be evaluated and adjusted. Gaps, loopholes, and ineffective provision that allow restricted weapons or military equipment to reach sanctioned actors must be identified and dealt with.

Any adjustments should be evidence-based and focused specifically on actors and activities contributing to instability. Those existing criteria should be applied consistently, using clear, well-substantiated evidence that identifies the person or entity, the conduct in question and its connection to the relevant criterion. Designations should be reviewed regularly to ensure they remain justified

and proportionate, while preserving due process and established procedures for exemptions and delisting. Attention should also be directed to documented arms-embargo evasion, including diversion, illicit transfers and the use of intermediaries. So as to ensure that any enforcement changes are evidence-based and focused on actors and activities that sustain violence.

Reporting, monitoring and information sharing

Monitoring mechanisms could also be strengthened by improving information-sharing between Member States, relevant UN bodies, customs authorities, and regional organizations to identify sanctions violations, illicit arms transfers, and attempts to circumvent existing restrictions. Last but not least, enforcement and accountability must be significantly improved by encouraging Member States to investigate and respond to violations of targeted sanctions and arms embargoes, while strengthening the reporting and follow-up mechanisms available to the Security Council.

Member States, particularly those whose authorities, ports, borders or financial systems may be relevant to suspected transfers, to share timely, verifiable information with the Panel and Committee, including shipment records, end-user details, financial links and evidence of diversion. Regular, focused panels which will be reporting arms flows, sanctions-evasion methods, impediments to monitoring and follow-up on prior recommendations, are of paramount importance. States ought to be encouraged to investigate credible allegations and report enforcement steps taken.

Further reading

- Halting the Catastrophic Battle for Sudan's El Fasher
- UN Documents for Sudan
- Sudan | OCHA
- Darfur, Sudan | International Criminal Court
- Sudan situation reports | UNICEF
- Sudan Publications : Security Council Report

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